was established in Fort Saint George in Madras on the same lines as the Court in Fort Saint William in Calcutta.

By 1813, in the East India Company Act of the same year, the Crown categorically spoke of its ‘undoubted sovereignty’ over the said territories and others. Critical to the discussion at hand on coloniality of the British coloniser are the provisions of the 1813 Act which related to ‘religion’, ‘morals’ and ‘education’. Reproduced herein below are the relevant excerpts of Section 33 of the 1813 Act:

> XXXIII: And whereas it is the duty of this country to promote the interest and happiness of the native inhabitants of the British dominions in India; and such measures ought to be adopted as may tend *to the introduction among them of useful knowledge, and of religious and moral improvement*: and in furtherance of the above objects, *sufficient facilities ought to be afforded by law to persons desirous of going to and remaining in India, for the purpose of accomplishing these benevolent designs, so as the authority of the local government respecting the intercourse of Europeans with the interior of the country to be preserved, and the principles of the British Government, on which the natives of India have hitherto relied for the free exercise of their religion, be inviolably maintained*: and whereas it is expedient to make provision for granting permission to persons desirous of going to and remaining in India for the above purposes, and also to persons desirous of going to and remaining there for other lawful purposes;… [emphasis added].

This extract succinctly captures the British Christian policy of toleration as discussed in Chapter 4.[16] On the one hand, it paid lip service to the right of the native inhabitants to practise ‘their religion’ freely, while on the other, it spoke of the ‘introduction’ of ‘useful knowledge’ to the natives and of their ‘religious and moral improvement’. Further, the provision spoke of extending all facilities needed to ‘persons going and remaining in India’ for the accomplishment of the ‘benevolent designs’ of the Christian White European coloniser. The coloniality of the coloniser is writ large in the express language of the provision itself which envisaged the civilising of the native through ‘religious and moral improvement’.